

Rewrite by completing the square.

original equation: $x^2 + x + 1$

Note: complete the square means:

find constants b, c such that

$$x^2 + x + 1 = (x + b)^2 + c$$

$$\Leftrightarrow x^2 + 2xb + b^2 + c$$

~~scribbles~~

$$\Leftrightarrow 2b = 1 \text{ and } b^2 + c = 1$$

$$\Rightarrow b = \frac{1}{2} \text{ and } \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^2 + c = 1$$

$$\Rightarrow b = \frac{1}{2} \text{ and } c = 1 - \frac{1}{4} = \frac{3}{4}$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 + x + 1 = \left(x + \frac{1}{2}\right)^2 + \frac{3}{4}$$

$$\therefore \left(x + \frac{1}{2}\right)^2 + \frac{3}{4}$$